



Casa Italiana of Dutchess County dba “The Italian Center”

A Cultural Organization [Organized in 1928](#) to Promote, Preserve, and Celebrate
Our Italian, and Italian American, History, Heritage, Culture, and Traditions

1195 Route 376, Wappingers Falls, NY 12590 USA Phone (845) 454-1492 (Leave Message)

[Facebook](#) | [Website](#) | [Membership](#) | [Member Portal](#) | [Contact](#)

OCTOBER 2026 NEWSLETTER

Bar Opens for Members and their Guests on Bocce Nights (Mondays 6:00PM - 8:00PM)
Come! Enjoy Your Club! Watch the Matches, a Game On TV, and/or Otherwise Socialize!

Bocce Games ended Oct. 5 with Bocce Teams' Dinner Oct 13, 6 PM. Monday Card Games start in November.

DINNER RESERVATIONS REQUIRED! Contact Ernie Bruno 845-594-5700 (hpsinger@optonline.net) by the Sunday before the dinners.

Website, Facebook, and Instagram input! Send to president@theitaliancenter.com and/or secretary@theitaliancenter.com!

Members' Meeting – Tuesday, October 6th, 2026

Cocktail hour (Cash Bar) starts 5:00PM - Dinner begins 6:00PM - Business 7:00PM - Dinner cost is \$30.
ATTENDEES ONLY MEMBERS IN GOOD STANDING - Paid Dues/Not in Suspension – Reservation Necessary!
Member Quorum necessary to conduct business. Please attend at 7:00PM even if you cannot participate in the dinner.

Menu - Meal Prepared by Chef Billy Schiffer and Tom Viani

Antipasto:	Pomodori, Carote Tagliuzzate, Cetriolo e Olive - Salad with Tomatoes, Shredded Carrots, Cucumber, Olives
Primo:	Spaghetti con olio e aglio - Spaghetti with oil and garlic Penne con un ragu – Penne with a ragu red sauce
Secondo:	Pollo parmigiana - Chicken parmigiana
Dolce:	Scelta dello chef – APPLE PIE ALLA MODE

Provincial Night – Tuesday, October 20th, 2026

Honoring Regione di Lazio and Provincia di Rieti. Cash Bar 6:00PM - Dinner 7:00PM

Hosted by Tony Daniele - **Don't miss the fun and the authentic delicious meal! SIGN-UP SOON!**

Reservation Necessary! Contact Ernie Bruno (845-594-5700 or hpsinger@optonline.net) - \$40 Member / \$45 Guest

Menu

Antipasto:	Lettuce, tomato, olives, fresh mozzarella cheese balls, served with house dressing and anchovies
Primo:	Pasta Amatriciana a typical pasta dish of Rieti with a red sauce with white wine and pancetta And Soup of rigatoni pasta e ceci (chickpeas) – a typical first course dish of Roma
Secondo:	Succulent pork roast with roasted seasoned potatoes/carrots - a pork dish typical of Lazio
Dolce:	Le Tisichelle (ti-si-chèl-le) a typical cookie of Lazio served with scoop of vanilla ice cream.

Frank LaManna's September 15th Provincial Night Honoring Regione di Puglia - Amazing Meal and Fun!



You know Pat, my little brother Lou does one heck of a job here! And Frank LaManna, how he presented this fabulous meal for ~\$40 is MAGIC!!



FOUR DOLLARS
FIVE DOLLARS

TACI Dick, Ernie is raffling off a pale yellow extra-long zucchini and I may want to bid on it!



Do I hear 6? Do I hear 6? No one? Going once! Going twice... sold to the man in the black for \$5!

CASPITA Ernie! Five Dollars!?! It cost us \$7 to grow it!!! Now how do I explain that to the Board, Ernie?!?

THIS OCTOBER WE'LL CELEBRATE THE REGIONE DI LAZIO E LA PROVINCIA DI RIETI



Lazio contains Italy's famous capital, Rome, and the famous small independent enclave known Worldwide as the Papal Seat or Vatican City. But Lazio is not all big city Rome any more than New York State is just New York City. Its south-west border is washed by the Tyrrhenian Sea, and it has miles of open sandy beaches with quaint little towns. The lower Tiber River flows through it and Lazio's interior contains farmland, wild marshes, forests, and mountains.

Today's Regione of Lazio was constructed in the period of 1920-1940 when the Italian fascist government was gerrymandering districts to consolidate and maintain power. In brief, here are the Provincie di Lazio:

La Provincia di [Rieti](#) which we'll examine more below.

La Provincia di [Roma](#) that dominates Lazio. Lots we can say about it, but for now [here is a tidbit](#) from earlier IC newsletter.

La Provincia di [Frosinone](#), established as a Provincia di Lazio in 1926 from territories belonging to the then provinces of Roma and Caserta. I find this interesting because I have Caserta blood in me and believe me my antenati were not fans of Roma! Indeed they identified as Neapolitani!

La Provincia di [Latina](#), established 1934, encompassing mainly the drained areas of the Agro Pontino marshes previously part of the province of Roma.

La Provincia di [Viterbo](#), allied with Roma for centuries, can be roughly divided into 4 districts (1) the coastal and flat area of the Lazio Maremma; (2) the Alta Tuscia, which is hillier and has a volcanic origin ([Lake Bolsena](#), in Viterbo, is the largest volcanic lake in Europe with extensive black sand beaches – it is pristine and its water is naturally potable); (3) the area of the Cimini Mountains around Lake Vico and the regions bordering the metropolitan city of Rome; (4) the eastern part bordering Umbria, and “bathed: by the Tiber River.



La Stemma of Lazio

LET'S EXPLORE THE PROVINCE OF [RIETI](#) MORE EXTENSIVELY



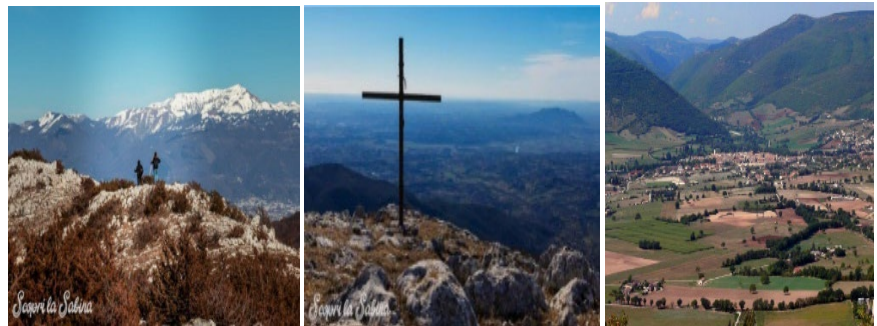
La stemma of Rieti

The [Provincia di Rieti](#) was formed in 1927 by the fascist regime of Mussolini. The stemma of Rieti symbolizes the uniting of areas that were politically separated prior to that regime. Note the SPQS across the stemma di Rieti; it means “the Senate and the People of Sabina”. SPQ (Senatus PopulusQue) was an ancient Roman slogan used to hype the grandeur of the Roman empire (something the fascists pretended to achieve). I could delve into that mark in history but instead let's explore Rieti's wonders!

Rieti supports a diversity of wildlife, particularly birds such as herons and little grebes. There are numerous natural oases, castles, fortresses, and Franciscan sanctuaries about the province of Rieti.

Rieti is a hiker's paradise! There are several protected areas in which to hike. To the south lies the [Parco regionale naturale dei Monti Lucretili](#), to the southeast the [Riserva regionale Montagne della Duchessa](#), and a small part of the Parco regionale naturale del Sirente-Velino. Between the two areas is the [Riserva naturale Monte Navegna e Monte Cervia](#) (between the lakes of Salto and Turano). In the east, in the Monti della Laga range is the [Parco Nazionale del Gran Sasso e Monti della Laga](#). Also of note is the [Riserva parziale naturale dei Laghi Lungo e Ripasottile](#) on the Rieti Plain, and the [Riserva naturale di Nazzano](#).

The most used by families might be [La Sabina in Rieti!](#) It resembles the mountainous regions of NYS It's a favorite of family trekkers out for a weekend of outdoors fun, as most of its wonders are reachable on foot by a normally fit family. In early Spring one can start in the immense expanse of leaves of the Poggio Perugino beech wood, then, going up, trample on preserved winter snow in the higher meadows, and finally climb the rocky ground that leads to the top of the Pizzuto, that offers fabulous panoramic views of bucolic central Bell'Italia!



Una ricetta rietina in breve for Pasta Amatriciana: *Spaghetti*, some good *pancetta* (must be black peppered), and a good *red sauce* in which you put *good white wine* to make it an Amatriciana. Render down the pancetta and stir in cooked pasta, add a *grated pecorino cheese*, a bit of hot pasta water, stir all to make a “cremina pecorina”. Add the “white wine-red sauce” to the pasta and mix.

PROVINCIAL NIGHTS ARE SPECIAL – INVITE FRIENDS AND FAMILY –FUN & FINE FOOD

Provincial Night October 20th, 2026. Honoring Lazio/Rieti - Hosted by Tony Daniele

Region	Date	Province	Sponsor(s)	Region	Date	Province	Sponsor(s)
Calabria	20-Jan-26	Catanzaro	Pat Fasolino	Lombardia	21-Jul-26	Bergamo	TBD
Toscana	17-Feb-26	Firenze	Tom Viani	Marche	18-Aug-26	P e U	BoD
Campania	17-Mar-26	Napoli	Mancarella Bros.	Puglia	15-Sep-26	Bari	Frank LaManna
Liguria	21-Apr-26	Genova	Paul Waldbillig	Lazio	20-Oct-26	Rieti	Tony Daniele
Sicilia	19-May-26	Tutte (all)	Giangrasso Family	Basilicata	17-Nov-26	Matera	Frank Marinaro
Emilia-Romagna	16-Jun-26	Reggio Emilia	Alberto Tripoli	No Provincial Night in December 2026 – Next 19 January 2027			



MUST WE REITERATE? PLEASE VOLUNTEER TO BE A PN SPONSOR!

Sponsor any TBD (No Sponsor Yet) date! Honor its designated, **or any open**, regione!

It's Fun, It's an Honor, It's Appreciated, It's Necessary for the Club's Viability!

Note: Regions Not Normally Duplicated in Same Year

<u>Region On Schedule</u>	<u>Logical Replacements Open</u>	<u>Sponsor</u>	<u>Date</u>
Lombardia	Friuli-Venezia Giulia Piemonte Trentino-Alto Adige Valle d'Aosta Veneto	TBD	21-Jul-26
Sardegna	Puglia Marche Molise Umbria	TBD	18-Aug-26

Italian roots? Use www.ancestry.com or www.italymondo.com to help you connect! Honor your antenati italiani via Provincial Night support!
Also, [here is a link that shows how Italy's Regions \(States\) evolved!](#)



We need volunteers to help to assist with setup, serving, and cleanup! We also need sponsors to fill in the TBDs!

Please contact Lou Piro at (845) 629-8905 or lgpiro@hotmail.com



Captain a Table, Fill It with Friends and Family, Volunteer to Entertain, Have Great Food and Good Cheer!



President's Letter

Fellow Brothers and Sisters,

The evenings have gotten chilly and the first day of fall arrived September 22nd. It's time for fruit picking and drinking fresh apple cider. We used to go apple picking with the kids when they were younger and made a day of it. We always ended up coming home with so many apples that we were giving them away to family and friends when we returned! Great memories!

Chef Billy did a great job on September Meeting Night dinner! The members enjoyed a toss salad, followed by Tri-color Tortellini with a bacon cream sauce and Rigatoni with a meat ragu. The entrée was Chicken Saltimbocca with broccoli rabe. Pumpkin pie topped off the meal for dessert. It was sooo good! Of course he didn't prepare this meal by himself. Helping in the kitchen were Sous Chef Tom Viani, Jeff Williams and Sal Polizzotto.

September Provincial Night was hosted by Frank LaManna. Frank created a terrific menu that started with a traditional Italian antipasto. The pasta course that followed was penne in a marinara sauce and linguini with garlic and oil. With this course, bowls of mussels in a marinara sauce were served family style. The most delicious Chicken Sorrentino was served with a side of roasted broccoli and shrimp scampi! You know if Frank is designing a menu there's going to be seafood in there somewhere and let me tell you the whole meal was superb! Assisting Chef Billy were Jeff Williams, Sal Polizzotto and John Casulli. Tom Viani was taking a well-deserved vacation!

No one would have been able to enjoy these meals without the set up staff, Jack Castelli, Lois Gaglione, Chris Sena, Paul Fortunato, and Irene Petro getting the dining room set up. Ernie Bruno handled reservations, Ray Pantaleo sold cards, Paul Waldbillig sold 50/50 tickets. Thank you everyone for all your help! It could not have been done without you!

The fall dinner dance was held on Saturday September 12th with 96 people attending. Chef Billy and the kitchen team of Souci Chef Tom Viani and Carmine Mastrangelo created a fantastic meal that everyone enjoyed while they danced to the music of "The Chain Gang". Ernie Bruno got up on the stage and did a song with the band and got a standing ovation! What a fun night! Mo Ricci, Chris Sena, Lois Gaglione, John Casulli and Jeff Williams can in on Friday and set up the dining room. Angela Bumstead created lovely table centerpieces for all the tables. Thank you all!!

Many Thanks to 1st Vice President Franco Giangrasso and his team of volunteers (Antonio Mazzarelli, Eric Violante, Carm Melilli, Mark Palazzolo, Ted Izzo, Jack Castelli, John Troisi, Vince Murray, Bruce Peterson, and Dan Giangrasso) that sacrificed their Saturday morning to clean out the storage unit. We used to have a bunch of stuff stored that we used for the Festa that we no longer needed but we're paying \$100 a month to store. Those guys cleaned it all out and now we can save \$1200 a year! Chris Larky, owner of Nieco Hauling, provided the dumpster. Thank you all for getting this done and saving the club some money!

The annual Bocce Tournament and Picnic is scheduled for Sunday September 27th [rescheduled to 3 Oct because of weather] from 1:00 PM to 5:00 PM. Hot dogs, hamburgers, sausage peppers and a wide variety of side dishes (made by volunteers) will be on the menu. Of course, the bar will be open for soft drinks and adult beverages. Last year we had a blast and the competition was tight. Even if you don't play bocce, come out for the picnic and watch the action!

We are hosting a comedy show on Saturday October 10th from 6PM to 10PM. Tickets are \$60.00 and include a 4-course dinner! Reservations are selling very quickly so don't hesitate, make a reservation now!

We are always in need of volunteers to help set up the dining room and assist in the kitchen for all events. Volunteers are essential to the success of this organization. I encourage everyone to sign up to help in some fashion.

Don't forget that the bar is open on Monday's from 6:00PM to 8:30PM. Come on out and watch the bocce league in action or stay inside and watch sports on TV. Please keep our sick and ailing members in your prayers.

Call or email me with any comments, questions or concerns at (845) 629-8905 or president@theitaliancenter.com.

I hope to see you around the club! Fraternally yours, Lou Piro, President

- [Please See Our Events below](#), visit [our website](#) and [our Facebook](#), LIKE us, join our activities, and have some fun.
- *We once were a Lodge of the Sons of Italy: here is a little [ITALIAN CENTER HISTORY](#).*
- *The [NIDO site](#) that has Italian references and IC cultural stuff categorized for us (Links).*

MEETING NIGHT HELPERS NEEDED - PLEASE VOLUNTEER

If you can assist with **tickets sales and setup** text or call: Lou Piro at 845-629-8905 or email at: lgpiro@hotmail.com

If you can assist with **kitchen and cleanup** text or call: Tom Viani at 914-475-6374 or email at: tlviani@aol.com

50/50 SUMMER RAFFLE
Only 100 Tickets Sold
GRAND PRIZE \$3,000.00
SECOND PRIZE \$1,500.00
THIRD PRIZE \$500.00
Drawing to be held October 6, 2026
Cost per ticket \$100.00

Drawing 6 Oct Mtg Nite!

>>>>> THE SUMMER 50/50 RAFFLE IS NOW LIVE! <<<<<
YOUR SUPPORT FOR SUCH RAFFLES HELPS MAINTAIN/IMPROVE YOUR CLUB!
EACH TICKET COSTS \$100 AND ONLY 100 TICKETS WILL BE SOLD!
THIS RAFFLE WILL SELL OUT QUICKLY! GET YOUR TICKET NOW!
TEXT OR CALL ERNIE BRUNO ON 845-594-5700 (AFTER 11:00AM)
OR EMAIL ERNIE AT: hpsinger@optonline.net
AGAIN! THIS RAFFLE WILL SELL OUT! CONTACT ERNIE BRUNO SOON!

Special Business - Meeting Minutes Report (September 2026)



President (Lou Piro): None

Chairperson of the Board (Ray Pantaleo): None

1st Vice President's Report (Franco Giangrasso): Franco mentioned that if anyone has a suggestion for meeting night meal, then see him. Franco mentioned that we need to clean out the storage unit and asked for volunteers to help. They should see him.

2nd Vice President's Report: [Volunteers Needed [Please See List Below.](#)] (Vince Murray) None

Treasurer's Report (Tom DiGiovanni) and Financial Secretary (Ron Knapp): In the Black

Membership (Ron Knapp/Paul Waldbillig) Initiated: Mike Siracusa (*Al Tripoli*) Geraldine Brucale (*Tina Ruggiero*) **Balloted and Approved:** Domenick Bizzaro (*Tony Daniele*) **Read:** Don Vizioli (*Geraldine Brucale*)

Marketing/Advertising (TBD): [Editor: also see [Marketing Committee Report](#)]: Position Vacant Please Volunteer.

Wellness (Sal Polizzotto): Vince Murray had a pacemaker installed yesterday. He went home yesterday afternoon. Lou Piro spoke to him and he is doing well.

Victor Bacile Scholarship (Paul Waldbillig): The 33rd Annual Anthony Comunale Golf Tournament which benefits the Dr. Victor A. Bacile Scholarship Fund was a wonderful success. The tournament was originally scheduled for August 3rd, which happened to be when Paul was in Italy. However, it was rained out. Therefore, the committee made a great decision to postpone it to August 17th. Luckily, Paul was able to make that date. When you consider corporate and event sponsors, tee signs, and general donations we made just as much or maybe even a hair above last year's great total. We don't know the final numbers as our treasurer is still counting the money for the raffles, contests, and the auction. More to come on that. Paul thanked the whole committee as this event can't run without everyone. They all did a wonderful job and each played critical roles: Vinnie Corona, George Harnen, Amy Bombardieri, Bob DiLullo, Doc Sabia, Lou Piro, Ray Pantaleo, Larry Zolnik, Joe Pantaleo, Al Capelli, Chris Mark, PJ Grippo, Chris Sena, Lois Caggiadi, Jody Chafouleas, Tom Viani, Joe Pedota, Irene Petro, Joyce Zolnik.

Planning Board (Tony Mancarella): The Progressive Ball is November 14th. The Children's Christmas Party to benefit needy children will be held on a date to be determined. Andrea McKeivitt mentioned that there is a hangup with regards to whether it is a security risk to have the families at the Italian Center.

Entertainment Committee (Ray Pantaleo): **Saratoga Bus Trip** – There was a bunch of people on the trip (mostly non-members). Ernie came along, which made it great. There was a small profit. **Bocce Tournament** – This will be on September 27th. [postponed to Oct 3rd because of weather] Ray urged people to sign up. Fall Dinner dance – Please sign up to make it a good event. **Comedy Night** – This will be on October 10th. Ray urged people to sign up. **Progressive Ball** – See above. (The Progressive Ball is November 14th.)

OLD BUSINESS: None

NEW BUSINESS: None

2026 IS THE ITALIAN CENTER'S 5TH YEAR OF NEW ACTIVE LIFE IN ITS NEW DIGS!

LET'S MAKE IT A GRAND 5TH ANNIVERSARY YEAR!

The 5th anniversary's ancient theme was represented in wood, exemplifying strength, and durability, much like a tree.

Today, silver is more commonly used as its theme, as it also represents those things, and being precious and pure.

The Italian Center is and should be strong, durable, and precious to us. Also, it is and should be pure, i.e., true to its charter, unselfish, and dedicated to its mission. **La Casa Italiana mission, in a nutshell:**



To foster a cultural connection among members, to preserve Italian traditions, to educate others in such, and to enhance the image of Italian Americans in the community we serve. It brings together people of similar heritage and encourages them to help one another, and it provides resources, activities, and events that foster camaraderie, understanding, and that bring some joy into our lives, and the lives of others.



The Italian Center has long stood as a symbol of Italian pride and an integral part of the Hudson River Valley landscape. When you join the Italian Center (La Casa Italiana), you take on its mission. Only we members can make our “Casa” great and true to its mission. In this 5th Anniversary of our NEW chapter of life, let us reflect on that 100+-year-old mission and rededicate ourselves to it.

You Asked for Activities – We Got Them – Status to Date 2026

FEB 14TH, 2026, VALENTINE'S DINNER DANCE

ANOTHER SUCCESS THANKS TO THE EFFORTS OF FRANCO GIANGRASSO AND HIS TEAM!

MAY 1ST, 2026, SPRING DINNER DANCE

ANOTHER SUCCESS THANKS TO THE EFFORTS OF MO RICCI AND HIS TEAM!

JULY 15TH, 2026, IWAGY PRESENTED WINES OF SICILY AND CAMPANIA

SUCCESSFUL FOR IWAGY HOWEVER NO CLUB MEMBERS ATTENDED

2026 TRIP TO SARATOGA SUNDAY, AUGUST 9TH ALWAYS A MAGNIFICENT EVENT!

SUCCESSFUL GREAT FUN AND GREAT BARGAIN HOWEVER WISH MORE MEMBERS PARTICIPATED

SEPTEMBER 12TH FALL DINNER DANCE – MO RICCI = A ROUSING SUCCESS

THESE PICTURES SAY IT ALL!!



FOR EVENTS TO COME See [Entertainment Below for Details](#)

Secretary's Report

Members and Friends of the Italian Center... If you need any information and/or have questions about the content of the newsletter or communications, please contact our Secretary:

Paul Waldbillig at (845) 242-0004 or secretary@theitaliancenter.com.

Also, if you have interesting entries for the Newsletter, please send them to newsletter@theitaliancenter.com. (Note the dates for submission below and submit them earlier than later).

Any questions and/or issues regarding the technical aspects of newsletter, website, social media or if you need your credentials for the private [Membership](#) section, please send an email to support@theitaliancenter.com.

Also, new [Membership Application](#) is currently available, so please pass it on to anyone whom you think might want to join and enjoy our club and make it even grander.

Would you like to share comments and/or suggestions directly with the Board of Trustees? If so, please send an email to the Chairman of the Board at: board@theitaliancenter.com.

Updated Newsletter Schedule		
<u>Submit Content Before</u>	<u>Publish By</u>	<u>Meeting Night</u>
Tuesday, October 20, 2026	Tuesday, October 27, 2026	Tuesday, November 3, 2026
Tuesday, November 17, 2026	Tuesday, November 24, 2026	Tuesday, December 1, 2026
Tuesday, December 22, 2026	Tuesday, December 29, 2026	Tuesday, January 5, 2027
Tuesday, January 19, 2027	Tuesday, January 26, 2027	Tuesday, February 2, 2027
Tuesday, February 16, 2027	Tuesday, February 23, 2027	Tuesday, March 2, 2027
Tuesday, March 23, 2027	Tuesday, March 30, 2027	Tuesday, April 6, 2027

PLEASE HELP/ENCOURAGE MEMBERS TO RECEIVE/READ NEWSLETTERS

([HTTP://WWW.THEITALIANCENTER.COM/MEMBERSHIP](http://www.theitaliancenter.com/membership))

PLEASE HELP US MAKE THE NEWSLETTER EVEN BETTER

They are in a permanent “corporate” data store open to us and the public because:

- They have publicity utility and help us fulfill our Corporate Charter to Promote our Culture/Heritage.
- They provide a historical record of our activity (a Monthly “Intentions/Commitments/Progress Report”).
- They provide space to honor Members, Our families, Italians/Things Italian, and our Achievements as a Club.

IT IS A TEAM EFFORT! MAKE OUR NEWSLETTERS EVEN BETTER! CONTRIBUTE MATERIAL, SUGGESTIONS, CRITIQUE, ETC.
READ IT! ENCOURAGE OTHERS TO READ IT!

Its “**Member Newsletter Submissions Section**” allows Members to share reminisces about the Club, relevant people, and to share knowledge of language and culture. Its “**Wellness Section**” allows Members to share fond memories of deceased members.

Remember this Pep Talk nestled in an Italian Lesson

Siciliano: “La manu curri spuntania a lu cori!”

Italiano: “La mano corre spontanea al cuore!”

Inglese/English (simply put): “Your hand runs according to your heart!”

Hidden Meaning: “Your work/actions reflect what is in your ‘heart’ (feelings/emotions)!”

In Context: “If we have a ‘love’ for our Casa Italiana we’ll gladly volunteer to help-out if we can!”

Do your part! It takes a village! A house is a house – a HOME (casa) is what you make it!

Remember: L’Unione fa la forza! – There is strength in numbers and unity!

and

Ogni cosa fa brodo – About anything can make broth – Every little bit helps – Do what you can!

IT IS A TEAM EFFORT! HELP MAKE OUR CLUB EVEN BETTER!

Entertainment Committee Report

Chair: Ray Pantaleo, rayp520@aol.com, 914-456-4761

Attendees at our events, including Provincial Nights, are **mostly nonmembers**.

We emphasize that we, with earnest effort, are trying to provide events that **benefit and please the Membership**.

More Member participation and support welcomed! Your ideas, your wants, and needs, welcomed!

>> **OCT 3RD SAT. 2ND ANNUAL BOCCE TOURNAMENT & BARBEQUE - JOE PEDOTA SARGE1912@AOL.COM**

[postponed to Oct 4th because of weather]

>> **OCTOBER 6 MEETING NIGHT – ERNIE BRUNO’S SUMMER 100 CLUB RAFFLE DRAWING**

>> **OCTOBER 10 COMEDY SHOW/DINNER**

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 10, 2026
DOORS 6:00PM ★ CASH BAR 6-10PM ★ DINNER 6:30-7:30PM ★ SHOW 7:30PM

ANTIPASTO PASTA ENTREE & DESSERT w COFFEE
★ \$60 PP ALL INCLUSIVE ★

RESERVATIONS RECOMMENDED • CONTACT RAY PANTALEO • 914-456-4761
1195 RT 376 • WAPPINGERS FALLS, NY 12590

THE ITALIAN CENTER

COMEDY SHOW & DINNER

★ FEATURING ★ **GENE TRIFILO** ★
★ HEADLINER ★ **CHRIS MONTE** ★
★ HOSTED BY ★ **RO RO ANTONUCCIO** ★

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1195 RT 376 • WAPPINGERS FALLS, NY 12590

>> **OCTOBER COLUMBUS DAY WEEKEND EVENT POTENTIALLY**

>> **OCTOBER 13 BOCCE TEAMS' DINNER 6PM @ IC (BOCCE TEAM MEMBERS ONLY)**

>> **NOV 14TH PROGRESSIVE BALL TONY MANCARELLA AMCHIRO1987@HOTMAIL.COM DETAILS/VOLUNTEER**

>> **DECEMBER ANNUAL MEMBER'S CHRISTMAS BUFFET**

>> **WINTER 100 CLUB RAFFLE WITH DRAWING AT MEMBER'S CHRISTMAS BUFFET**

>> **JANUARY AT THE CLUB "THE RETURN OF JETS-GIANTS FOOTBALL PARTY" WITH PRIZES, A FUN EVENT HOSTED BY FRANCO GIANGRASSO & RAY PANTALEO**

Italian Center Progressive Ball

11/14/2026



*Honoring
Matt Aiello
Tony Daniele
Kirk Imperati
Vincent Murray*

1 hour Hors d'oeuvres

Salad Pasta

Main Dish Choice of

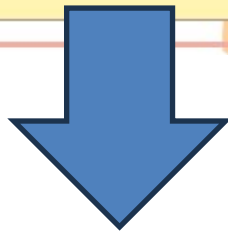
Braised Short Rib, Chicken Marsala or Salmon

Desert Coffee/Tea Cash Bar Music

\$75 per person Tips and Tax included (Paid in advance)

Reservations text Tony Mancarella 845-797-4773 Include name and phone#

If you want to reserve a table for a group of people, please put one person in charge to collect money and food choices. All reservation paid in full by 11/6/2026



ITALIAN CENTER PROGRESSIVE BALL 14 NOVEMBER 2026

AT THE ITALIAN CENTER



Honorees:

Matt Aiello	Anthony Daniele
Kirk Imperati	Vince Murray

1-hour Hors d'oeuvres
Cash Bar

Menu

Salad

Pasta

Main Dish Choice of

Braised Short Rib, Chicken Marsala, or Salmon

Desert

Coffee/Tea

Music and Dancing

\$75 Per Person Tips and Tax Included (Paid In Advance)

For Reservations Text Tony Mancarella 845-797-4773 Include Name and Phone Number
All Reservations Must Be Paid in Full By 11/6/2026

If You Want to Reserve a Table for a Group of People,
Please Put One Person in Charge to Collect Money and Food Choices.

Please Be a Sponsor

Please Provide Completed Ad (Some Ads May Need to Be Reformatted)

Full Page \$150.00

Half Page \$75

Quarter Page \$50

To Place Adds or Any Questions Contact:

Chris Sena Cell 516-776-3312 Email betteangelo@verizon.net
Lois Gaglione Cell 845-242-8321 Email lgaglione22@gmail.com

Marketing/Advertising Committee Report

We need a chairperson – This committee could be pivotable!

Objectives of the Committee

*Increase Club Membership, General Member Participation, and the Club's Presence in our community!
Increase Attendance and Support for Our Activities, Events, Fundraising*

Possible Strategies for Achieving these Objectives

*Increase Club Presence on Social Media and in Local "News" Media
Update the Website and Newsletter, and Increase Their Penetration into the Community
Interested in bringing the Club back into the light? Contact Secretary! Join the Committee!*

On Friday, September 26th, our new and improved website went live! Have you visited www.theitaliancenter.com to check out our fresh look along with a new online calendar of events? Have you visited the updated Member Only Portal!

For all the latest Italian Center news, be sure to like us on Facebook and follow us on Instagram @TheItalianCenterNY.

*Again, interested in bringing the Club back into the light?
Get material to put on our social media!
Have Material to Put In our public media then contact Secretary!
Like us on [Facebook](#) and follow us on [Instagram](#).*

LET'S MAKE IT HAPPEN!

Do Your Part to Keep Our Social Media Living and Breathing!

[Website](#) | [Facebook](#) | [Instagram](#)

Have something to put in those or feel something is missing?

*Send material or thoughts to the [President](#) or [Secretary](#)
president@theitaliancenter.com | secretary@theitaliancenter.com*

And Don't Forget to Like Us on Facebook!

Dr. Victor A. Bacile Scholarship Award Program

The Program has awarded 131 scholarships valued at more than \$279K to date 2025. Each 2026 Scholarship will be \$4,000!

This program is **only** open to Italian Center members in good standing, their spouses, and their children. Not all applicants receive a scholarship, but the odds are good, and it is a significant IC Membership perk.

For general information, access this link: <http://www.theitaliancenter.com/scholarship>.

VERY IMPORTANT!

Applicants must submit their Applications by End of September!!!!

Click Link Here for Criteria and Application

[Dr. Bacile Scholarship Application \(2026\)](#)

If you would like to volunteer or have specific questions, please email scholarship@theitaliancenter.com or call **Joe Pantaleo**, (845) 462-4080. Officers: Paul Waldbillig - President, Bob DiLullo - Treasurer, Joe Pantaleo - Secretary. Representing the Italian Center on the Board are Amy Bombardieri, Bob Civitano, Vinny Corona, George Harnen, Jeff Waldbillig, Al Cappelli, Bob DiLullo, Joe Pantaleo, Ray Pantaleo, Lou Piro, Mo Ricci, Paul Waldbillig, and Dr. Larry Zolnik .

The 8/17/26 Bacile Golf Tournament Was a Rousing Success!

THE ITALIAN CENTER, THE PLAYERS, AND DONORS/ BUSINESS SPONSORS HELP MAKE THE BACILE SCHOLARSHIPS POSSIBLE!
GRAZIE MILLE (MANY THANKS) TO OUR GENEROUS DONORS AND BUSINESS SPONSORS!

PERSONAL SPONSORS	BUSINESS SPONSORS - PLEASE THINK ABOUT USING THEM! The links provided are presumed safe and accurate, however, always use normal technical safeguards and due diligence when accessing links/conducting business.	
Ernie Bruno Al Cappelli Joseph Cavaccini, Wapp. Town Supervisor Vin & Barbara Corona Nick D'Assessandro, EF Supervisor Anthony DiLullo In Memory of Joe Fiacco The Foscaldi Family Sheriff Kirk Imperati Lou & Angela Piro Richard (Dick) Piro Jim and Ray Sabia Dr. John Sabia Silvestri Family In Memory of Berto Vecchiarelli Jeff & Stephanie Waldbillig Paul and Brenda Waldbillig	A&R Security Systems Arbor Capital Wealt Advisors ARTCPA Accounting Bottini Fuel BTA Builders CR Properties Dalleo Insurance Dunkin - Chen Management Group, Inc. Dutchess Diner DVM Industries Gold's Gym Hopewell Hot Bagels Firehouse Bottling - Hot Drama Hudson Rive Truck and Trailer IWAGY (Wine Connoisseurs) Joseph Small NW Mutal Ins. Justin LaFalce Real Estate	La Deliziosa Italian Pastries M&O Septic Services Mid-Hudson Limousine MMG Fire Equipment Mora Chiropractic Moe Ricci Electric Poughkeepsie Rural Cemetery Prager M�tis Advisors/Accounting Premier Medical Group Scott Marxer Insurance Siegrist Construction Small World Wealth Mgmt. Stenger, Glass, Etc, LLP (Family Law) Sweets Funeral Home Torsone Funeral Homes Van DeWater Attorneys Viscount Wines and Liquors Williams Lumber Wireless Edge Towers

Other Scholarship and Educational Opportunities

Our Dr. Bacile Scholarship is a perk for IC members' children and spouses. Here are few other scholarship opportunities:

**[Columbus Citizens Foundation](#) * [National Italian American Foundation](#) * [UNICO Foundation](#)
[National Organization of Italian American Women](#) * [Order Sons and Daughters of Italy in America](#)
STUDY ABROAD [U.S. Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs](#)**

IC Bocce Games 2026 Ended 5 Oct 2026 - Team Members' Dinner 13 Oct 6 PM @ IC!
Cash Bar Will Be Open for Business Mondays When Games (Bocce or Cards) Scheduled

ITALIAN CARD NIGHTS WILL START IN NOVEMBER
WILL REPLACE BOCCE GAMES (ENDED 5 OCT 2026) ON MONDAYS
CASH BAR WILL BE OPEN FOR BUSINESS MONDAYS WHEN GAMES OCCUR
CHAIR: CARD NIGHT - PHIL SCIUTO - PSHOETOE@HOTMAIL.COM

BOCCE LEAGUE GAMES EVERY MONDAY EVENINGS PROMPTLY AT 6:00

Unless Cancelled/Rescheduled for Weather, Etc.

Bocce League Chair - Joe Pedota at sarge1912@aol.com

THE FOUR SPONSORS (TEAMS) FOR BOCCE NIGHT ARE:

GINO'S PIZZA & RESTAURANT (GREEN)

GINO GEMMATI

[HTTPS://WWW.GINOSPIZZERIAS.COM/](https://www.ginospizzerias.com/)

M. RICCI ELECTRIC (RED)

MAURIZIO RICCI

[HTTPS://WWW.MRICCIELECTRIC.COM/](https://www.mriccielectric.com/)

MILANESE ITALIAN RESTAURANT (BLACK)

SANTINO MILANESE

[HTTPS://WWW.FACEBOOK.COM/MILANESERESTAURANT/](https://www.facebook.com/milaneserestaurant/)

JD'S PUB & BREW (BLUE)

GINO GEMMATI

[HTTPS://WWW.JDPUBNBREW.COM/](https://www.jdpubnbrew.com/)

[POSTPONED TO OCT 3RD BECAUSE OF WEATHER]

OPEN BOCCE TOURNAMENT & PICNIC

- Cash Bar & Music
- Group Trivia Game
- NFL Games, Cornhole Games
- Sausage & Peppers, Hamburgers, Hot dogs
- 50/50 Raffle

\$20 Admission per person • Includes food
Open to all members & 1 guest per member
(Anyone can play)

Sunday September 27th, 2026 1PM-5PM
1195 Route 376, Wappingers Falls



Contact Bocce Chair Joe Pedota: sarge1912@aol.com
Jack Castelli: jjcastelli@aol.com
Paul Fortunato: paulfortunato017@gmail.com
Anthony Giovinazzi: anthony.giovinazzi@gmail.com

SEPTEMBER 27TH 2ND ANNUAL BOCCE 1PM-5PM
TOURNAMENT & BARBEQUE - JOE PEDOTA
SARGE1912@AOL.COM

If you plan to attend/bring a guest, please email this information to Joe directly or call him by 20th so there is an accurate count for food.

Members can help by bringing a side (a salad, or a dessert) please let Joe Pedota know and mention which item you could provide so there are no duplicates of the same items.

It is preferred that members pay \$20 per person by September's Provincial Night or soon thereafter. Joe will be there to collect. In any case please pay (get money to Joe) before the event date!

Direct email links:

Joe Pedota sarge1912@aol.com

Jack Castelli jjcastelli@aol.com

Paul Fortunato paulfortunato017@gmail.com

Anthony Giovinazzi anthony.giovinazzi@gmail.com

Volunteer Opportunities for Members

Renovation Committee Needs Your Physical/Logistical Help, Expertise, Equipment

If you can help, let Vincent Murray know at (845) 724-3154 | (914) 456-7448, vicepresident2@theitaliancenter.com.

Servers, Kitchen Help, Set Up/Tear Down for Club Events

Volunteers needed especially for our Regular Meeting Nights and Provincial Nights

PLEASE If you can help, let Lou Piro know (845) 629-8905, president@theitaliancenter.com.

WE RELY ON OURSELVES TO MAKE GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

This Is Our Club, Make Your Mark, Have Some Fun, And Honor Your Heritage!

We are truly blessed to have members with skills, resources, and devotion that generously help us do things we could not do without their support. Whether it is rebuilding our staircase, fixing the plumbing, serving a great meal on Provincial Night, running a committee, being a Board Member, or whatever, we'd be lost without our Members' Support!

BE AN ACTIVE MEMBER! IT IS FUN. IT HAS REWARDS, IT IS NECESSARY!



If you would like to help with our facilities, please contact our 2nd Vice President, Vincent Murray at (845) 724-3154 | (914) 456-7448, vicepresident2@theitaliancenter.com.

Here Is the Current List of Things We Need Help to Do!

Note: Not A Complete List – **We Can Always Find Ways to Use Your Talents!**

Finished Club Tasks

- Assist hanging privacy panels in men's room
- Bollards to prevent people from parking on grass
- Clean out rear gutter and other gutters
- Electrical work for fire alarm inspection
- Fill in depression over septic tank
- Finish painting the building
- Hang TV in Bar and connect to cable
- Mount AED box in the lobby
- Power wash kitchen carts
- Repair Gutter
- Repair pipe for septic
- Replace sink washers in multiple sinks
- Clean out rear gutter
- Fill ditch by mailbox
- Prune trees around the property
- Put up PVC strip in bathroom
- Replace batteries for emergency exits
- Replace sink washers in multiple sinks

Indoor Club Tasks

- Clean & Paint Kitchen floor and walls
- Clean and repair some of the dining room chairs
- Fill in gaps around the front door
- Floor mats in dish room
- Grab bars in bathroom stalls
- Organize and possibly improve attic flooring
- Paint Bar door and molding
- Paint molding around front door
- Repair bathroom sheet rock
- Repair chairs
- Replace outlet by men room door in foyer
- Help re-assemble the bocce/utility shed

Outdoor Club Tasks

- Clean out the storage unit to eliminate monthly cost
- Clean up and out the trailer we have at Bottini's
- Fill in channels around stairs and seed
- Hide heat tape wires in soffit
- Mount No Parking signs in front of the building
- Mount One way traffic signs in front of building
- Paint Handicap ramp
- Repair sidewalk



Membership Committee Report

Please take a moment to update your member information... If you have had some changes or simply would like to update your information with us, please send us an email at membership@theitaliancenter.com. If you are interested in helping the Membership Committee or have ideas on how to attract and sustain good members, please contact **Al Tripoli** (application management) at membership@theitaliancenter.com or advertising@theitaliancenter.com.

Our Club is special and unique in the area. It has been and should continue to be something special in the lives of its members and the community – get involved – help it grow and thus improve.

**ASK SOMEONE TO JOIN OUR CLUB - BECOME INVOLVED IN COMMITTEES
SHARE OUR MONTHLY NEWSLETTER - VOLUNTEER WHEN YOU SEE MEMBERS NEED HELP**

September 2026's New Members Initiated:



Geraldine Brucale (*Tina Ruggiero*)
Mike Siracusa (*Al Tripoli*)

MAKE THE ITALIAN CENTER A FAMILY AFFAIR!
HELP GROW PRODUCTIVE MEMBERSHIP - SPONSOR GOOD APPLICANTS MALE **AND** FEMALE
HELP MAKE THIS CLUB EVEN MORE VIBRANT!

Do you know someone who would like to become a member of our club?

Check out the updated [MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION](#) and pass onto friends and family that might join and enjoy our Club!

**Membership Dues Can Be Paid by Credit Cards or Cash at the Bar, Or Send Your Check To:
The Italian Center, Attn: Ron Knapp FS, 1195 Route 376, Wappingers Falls, NY 12590**

Wellness Committee Report

Sal Polizzotto is the Wellness Chairperson! Members must be his eyes, ears, and representatives. **Report member wellness information to Sal Polizzotto** at (845) 590-7319 or wellness@theitaliancenter.com.

Please volunteer to serve on the Wellness Committee. It serves and honors our members by helping them and their families in times of need. When members are in the hospital, ill, convalescing, or have passed, please let Sal or the president know of such instances and/or of the status. The Committee and the Board will take it from there and decide/take appropriate action.

General - Sick at Home or Hospitalized, Convalescing at Home or in Rehab

Residing at Assisted Living Facilities

Bob Spinello (100 years old; oldest member) is in Lutheran care

Deceased Members (Within Recent Membership Cycle)



9/7/2026

3/27/2026

1/13/2026

1/9/2026

Walter R. Corrado - 88

Paul Sebastian Mancarella - 71

Giulio Di Giacomo - 92

Marquis G. "Marc" VanDeWater - 83

11/29/2025

11/5/2025

11/4/2025

9/26/2025

8/10/2025

Mario Bertolozzi - 95

John M. Angiulli - 80

John Bordi Jr. - 91

Leonard Spinelli - 88

Carlo Marinaro - 66



Walter R. Corrado, born on November 3, 1938, in Fiume Veneto, Italy, the son of the late Domenico and Ferdinanda Narduzzo Corrado, passed away on September 7, 2026, in Hyde Park, New York. On October 17, 1959 Walter married Pina DiTonno. Walter was a local resident for over 60 years. He was a dedicated member of the Italian Center. Walter was a self-employed tiler who took great pride in his craft. He was known for his love of trap and skeet shooting, dancing, and cherished Sundays spent with his wife. Walter leaves behind his loving wife, Pina Corrado; his son, Marco Corrado; brothers, Angelo and Mathilde DeMichiel Corrado, Mario Corrado; and sister, Lydia Lutz Corrado. He was preceded in death by his daughter, Vivian M. Corrado. Entombment will at Poughkeepsie Rural Cemetery. In lieu of flowers, contributions may be made to the Hudson Valley Hospice House.

Editorial Comment: The sad passing of our dear brother and friend, Walter (Valter) R. Corrado, is another step toward an end of an era. With his fellow Italians Berto Vecchiarelli, Maria Moore, and others of his ilk, he made quite a team. They were part of a core of accomplished kind and giving native Italians very active in the Italian Center. We owe them, because of their generous skillful volunteerism, for our existence today. Personally speaking, ten years my elder, "Valter" was an inspiration to me! Always a gentleman, always kind and giving of himself. When I interacted with "Valter" I always felt like I was interacting with an older friend. We'd talk whenever appropriate in Italian; his was perfect, and he'd patiently and expertly try to help me relearn mine. I think many of us in the Italian Center can empirically attest to what I say: "Valter" Corrado was one heck of an IC member and a guy! We will miss him deeply but certainly he deserves to rest in peace – he earned that!" Below is an example of Valter's contribution to the Center!

SEPTEMBER 2013 IN THE POUGHKEEPSIE JOURNAL

Three Cheers - Pok Journal Editorial

Three Cheers... to the always delicious annual Festa Italiana, the annual three-day outdoor party which was held at the Italian Center. Located in an old Italian neighborhood at 227 Mill Street in Poughkeepsie, the Center's roots reach back to the 19th century influx of Italian immigrants to Dutchess County, when work was plentiful in construction, railroads, and bridge building. Families enjoyed pizza and cannolis at the Festival. Music was performed by more than 10 groups and there were games for all ages. A celebration of food and culture, The Festa Italiana is a labor of pride and love. The event, led by co-Chairs Berto Vecchiarelli and Walter Corrado, requires close to 6,000 volunteer hours, and hosted more than 15,000 visitors.

"It gives the community an opportunity to savor the Italian Culture," said John Mazzetti, Secretary of the Italian Center.

FROM OUR THEN ESTEEMED PRESIDENT,
JOE PANTALEO

"Grazie! Grazie! to all of you who were able to help at our annual Festa last month. We would not have been able to offer this event without all the volunteer hours that you gave us. From the set-up crews, electricians, cooks, runners, servers, cashiers, raffle sellers, etc., we were able to offer our community a great experience. ... a lot of planning [was] involved and coordination of chores. Above all others, I must recognize and thank the extraordinary efforts of **Walter Corrado, Berto Vecchiarelli, Dom Letterii and Maria Moore**. Where do they get their energy? ..."

[Editorial Comment: Pina (Valter's wife) was also active in helping the Center; a wonderful partner!]

Member Newsletter Submissions



Use this section to share fond memories of the Club, its members, or knowledge/experiences regarding our Italian/Italian American history, culture, and/or language. **CONTRIBUTE! You can leave formatting/wordsmithing to us!**

Send your entries to secretary@theitaliancenter.com or president@theitaliancenter.com!

Since we honor Lazio in October, I will present some literary/cinematic culture regarding modern Rome.

Then we have a beautiful article from Paul Waldbillig recounting his family's wonderful trip to Milano, Lombardia!

reface: Here are links to things Laziali from previous IC Newsletters:

[“Racconti Romani” \(films and stories cast in 1950s Lazio by Alberto Moravia\).](#)

[“Little Disney in Rome – Cinecittà”,](#)

[A bit about Latina in Lazio and a Fable,](#)

[An unforgettable film set in WWII and set in Roma - “La ciociara” starring Sofia Loren.](#)

The Bicycle Thieves (Ladri di biciclette), an Unforgettable Story/Film of Post-WWII Desperation Cast in Roma!



There is a saying in English something like “You cannot get blood from a rock.” In Sicilian there is a saying that may convey something similar but also I felt it meant a bit more, it goes along the lines of you cannot bring a person lower if that person is already at rock bottom; it goes something like this in Sicilian “Centu latri nun ponno spugghiari un nudu” and in Italian “Cento ladri non possono spogliare un uomo nudo” and translated to English “One hundred thieves cannot steal the clothes off a naked man”.

This film, “The Bicycle Thieves (Ladri di biciclette)”, is a poignant story of a just post-WWII family in Rome and their struggles to stay above water in a challenging time in Italy’s history, and in a city that could be cruel. A story of a man not quite “un nudu” who was given a means of “success” – a paying job that required a bicycle! He had a bicycle, he had the fortitude, he had hope. And then some thieves took that away by stealing his bike, essentially making him incapable of supporting his family and thus stripping him of all dignity. The man descended to rock bottom. The man was made “un nudu” – devoid of his manhood and hope – feeling of no use to himself let alone his family and pushing him to his own destruction.

Click on the picture to the left or this [link](#) to read a more detailed account of it. Also, here is link to it on [YouTube](#) with English subtitles. It is in my opinion one of the finest post-WWII theme movies ever made!

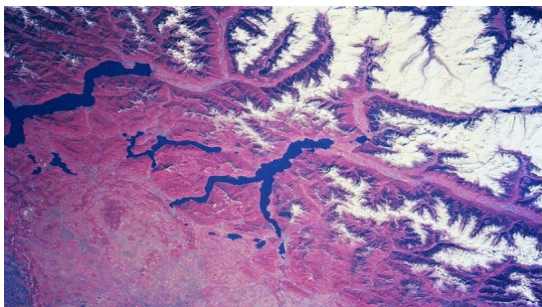
A Very Entertaining AI Generated Look at Roma 27BC to 180AD!

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9tQ4glcJkFk>



Paul and his family invading Lombardia?

Nope, it's the Longobard King Alboin entering Pavia in 568 AD. King Alboin's victory resulted in Lombardia! Pavia is a historic university city in the Lombardy region of northern Italy, located about 20 miles south of Milan along the Ticino River.



Preface: Some things about Lombardia and Milano in previous IC Newsletters:

[The Regione di Lombardia](#)

[A tidbit about Milano today](#)

[A tidbit about Milano mid-20th century](#)

THE WALDBILLIG FAMILY VACATION IN MILANO AND BEYOND

Nice Article by Paul Waldbillig – Sidelines by Tony Daniele

My mother took my family and my brother's family to Italy this summer. She always wanted to go back because she hadn't been there since she was in her 20s.

We have cousins that live in Milano and my daughter, Elena, visited them last year and loved it so it was a perfect place for our group of 11 to go to.

We rented an Air BnB and used that as our hub to visit other sites. Besides seeing the general city of Milano we went to the following:

- 1) The Milano Duomo 2) Lake Como 3) Lake Garda*
- 4) Florence 5) Lugano, Switzerland*

Of these places, I have to say Lake Como was definitely my favorite! We went on a personal 3-hour boat ride around the lake and even got to swim! The views were amazing! Also, the driver showed us places owned by George Clooney and the Versaces, which was pretty cool.

It was absolutely wonderful spending lots of time with our cousins and of course thoroughly enjoyed the great food, whether it be Steak Florentine, prosciutto, pizza, pasta, and of course the tasty gelato!

Lastly, we even spent one afternoon participating in a cooking class making two types of pasta, one with a pesto sauce and another with traditional tomato-based sauce. For dessert, we made tiramisu. Everything was so good!

Our trip was a once in a lifetime experience for my mom and family to experience with her. We will definitely go back; we have lots more to see and enjoy. Yours truly, Paul Waldbillig

Lombardia houses "Italy's Great Lakes" – left to right: Lake Maggiore (upper left corner), Lake Lugana, Lake Como (center of image), and Lake d'Iseo (lower right corner). Smaller lakes (also dark features).

Heading SE from Maggiore is the u-shaped valleys that lead to flat plains (lighter color). These plains are highly industrialized and agriculturally productive. Here (lower left third of satellite image) begins the super fertile Po River Valley that extends approximately 400 miles into Italy.

A FESTIVAL IN PARMA IN REGIONE EMILIA-ROMAGNA – REPORTED BY A FRIEND OF MINE THERE



From Franco Caruso: “Ciao Tony, yesterday we travelled to Rome [where they live]. A few days before we were in Parma [where his wife is from and has family that owns a big cheese factory]. There was an interesting event by the Piazza Garibaldi, the former Roman Forum. Here you can see some pictures of this “Cena dei Mille”, the funghi [mushrooms] of Borgotaro, the prosciutto di Parma, unique extra virgin olive oil, etc. Only 1000 people were accepted through the internet. All the places were taken the same day of the posting!”

The “Cena dei Mille”, the “Dinner of the 1000”, is an exclusive event (limited to 1000 people!). It is certainly one of Italy’s most celebrated culinary events. Set in Parma, thus in the heart of the renowned Food Valley, this unique gourmet experience combines history, culture and gastronomy in perfect harmony. This year it was held on 8 September 2026.

But if one misses it, one can discover (perhaps with a guide) the charm of Parma’s historic center, and its fabulous cuisine, anytime, by strolling through its elegant squares, picturesque streets, and remarkable historic sites. There one can discover the city’s artistic and architectural treasures while being immersed in the mouthwatering aromas.



Now here is something that must have graced those tables – Authentic Parmigiano-Reggiano Cheese!!!

Authentic hard-paste Parmigiano-Reggiano Cheese is produced ONLY in a very specified geographical area that includes Parma, Reggio Emilia, Modena, and Bologna. Only cows bred, raised, and milked in that area, under strict husbandry rules can supply the milk for authentic P-R Cheese. That milk is a valuable commodity sold on Italy’s richest commodity exchanges. Also, the cheese’s production is subject to strict specifications. If you buy “hard cheese” not blessed by that Consortium in Reggio you are not buying Parmigiano-Reggiano Cheese – and one can easily taste the difference!

WHAT WE WERE DOING TOGETHER TOWARD THE END OF SUMMER 2009

Members See Yanks Sweep Sox

As predicted, the first Italian Center "Magic Bus Trip" to the new Yankee Stadium on Sunday, August 30th, was a great success on all counts!

First and foremost, our 45 members enjoyed the 8-3 Yankee rout of the White Sox with some 46,619 other fans in attendance in the sold-out 52,325 seat palatial park. This game concluded the Bombers' 4 game sweep of the Pale Hose Boys. This was predicted here as the Bombers' revenge for the almost-sweep of the Yanks in Chicago on August 2nd.

So our gang got to see the brand new palace that George (Steinbrenner, not Ruth) built, as well as an action-packed game started by the always-entertaining Joba Chamberlain, and finished by a total of 5 relievers for the Yanks. Not like the old days, when Whitey Ford would pitch the entire game! On the hitting side, Deter

Jeter led the team at bat. He had two hits and a walk to score 3 runs, thus closing in on Lou Gehrig's 70-year-old record, and improving his batting average to .335 (Of course, Jeter did break the Iron Horse's record only 12 days later on September 11th, when he singled to the right field corner for his 2,722 career hit for Yankees).

The genial guide and host-with-the-most, Tony Comunale, said that the breakfast at the Club, the weather, the bus ride, the refreshments, and even the parking and walking, were just fine. He promises to get even better seats for next year's game right after New Year's Day. So keep that in mind and get your dibs in for 2010!

John Mottalini

Ten years later dear Brother Comunale ceased being with us physically, but he remains with us in spirit! See below.



All smiles in the stands at the new Yankee stadium.



"Take me out to the ballgame!"

ON 16 SEPTEMBER 2019 WE LOST DEAR BROTHER TONY COMUNALE

Tony loved to golf, to dance every Friday night at the Italian Center, and build furniture as a hobby.

But more essentially, he loved making his community and people happier and better!

Tony retired as the respected Director of Guidance at Poughkeepsie High; after retirement he was an Education Consultant for DC BOCES and was active in the NYS Vocational Guidance Association.

Tony was involved in the IC, and he served in many challenging officer and chairperson positions.

He gave so much of himself to his community and our Italian Center!

He was an overall fine person who represented his Italian Heritage well.

Rest in peace Tony, we remember you fondly!

**ON 10 SEPTEMBER 2001 WE PUT ON A WONDERFUL FESTA AT THE OLD CENTER
ON 11 SEPTEMBER 2001 OUR WORLD CHANGED FOREVER**

Why do I juxtapose those two events? Because that Festa is always in my thoughts as I remember the event that we now call “9-11”.

The Festa we put on 10 Sept 2001 was blessed with clear blue skies and perfect temps. I remember that Festa,
I remember how hard we all worked as a team to put together that Festa and run it,
I remember how crowded with happy attendees it was.

I remember that Sept 11th Monday, when work stopped and we huddled together in shock, seeking news and guidance.

I remember my thought at that moment and that reoccurs every commemoration of “9-11”.

. The thought is this: “How, after such a beautiful day of peace and love (our Festa) could such an horrible thing happen!?”

To me at least, that “9-10” IC Festa” will always be juxtaposed with “9-11”!

One representing the wonderful beauty of people and community, the other representing the ugly foolish side of mankind!

Though the pics below are of 2006, they hopefully represent the effort and joy of that Festa Sunday, 10th of September 2001!



Contact List

[\(Return Top\)](#)



Casa Italiana of Dutchess County dba “The Italian Center”
1195 Route 376, Wappingers Falls, NY 12590 USA
Phone (845) 454-1492 (Leave Message)



[Facebook](#) | [Website](#) | [Membership](#)

For General Concerns and Comments: president@theitaliancenter.com
For Membership Questions and Concerns: membership@theitaliancenter.com
For Technical and/or Web Support: support@theitaliancenter.com

Board of Directors	Email
Chairman - Ray Pantaleo (Elected 2025)	board@theitaliancenter.com
President - Lou Piro	president@theitaliancenter.com
1st Vice President - Franco Giangrasso	vicepresident1@theitaliancenter.com
2nd Vice President - Vincent Murray	vicepresident2@theitaliancenter.com
Treasurer - Tom DiGiovanni	
Secretary - Paul Waldbillig	secretary@theitaliancenter.com
Director - Jack Castelli	jjcastelli@aol.com
Director - Mark Palazzolo	map5662@yahoo.com
Director - Tom Viani	tlviani@aol.com
Committee Chairs	
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Membership - Al Tripoli	membership@theitaliancenter.com
Marketing/Advertising - Tom Martinelli, Chair	advertising@theitaliancenter.com
Newsletter/Website - Tony Daniele	newsletter@theitaliancenter.com
Planning - Tony Mancarella	planning@theitaliancenter.com
Wellness - Sal Polizzotto	wellness@theitaliancenter.com
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Building & Grounds - Vincent Murray	vicepresident2@theitaliancenter.com
Entertainment - Ray Pantaleo	rayp520@aol.com
League/Activity Chairs	
Golf League - Mark Webber	golfleague@theitaliancenter.com
Bocce League - Joe Pedota	bocce@theitaliancenter.com
Card Night - Phil Sciuto	pshoetoe@hotmail.com
Scholarship Golf Tournament - Paul Waldbillig	scholarshipgolf@theitaliancenter.com